

NERVE

1. Passage anchor

> “Some parts **hit a nerve**, especially the sections about self-blame and unrealised potential...”

Passage meaning

hit a nerve = touch on a sensitive emotional issue that causes a strong reaction

觸動敏感點；戳中痛處；引起強烈共鳴

Here, the book touches on themes that feel personally sensitive or emotionally close to the speaker.

Practice

1. The chapter about regret really **hit a nerve**.

關於後悔的那一章真的**戳中了我的痛處**。

2. His comment **hit a nerve** because it reminded her of an old insecurity.

他的話**觸動了她的敏感點**，因為讓她想起過去的不安。

Core meanings of NERVE

2. nerve — anatomical structure

= bundle of fibers that carries messages between the brain/spinal cord and the rest of the body

神經

Examples

1. The injury damaged a **nerve** in his hand.

那次受傷損傷了他手上的一條**神經**。

2. The dentist tried to avoid touching the **nerve**.

牙醫盡量避免碰到**神經**。

This is the central literal sense.

3. nerve endings

= ends of nerves that detect pain, touch, temperature, etc.

****神經末梢****

Examples

1. The skin contains many ****nerve endings****.
皮膚裡有很多****神經末梢****。
2. Cold can affect the ****nerve endings**** in your fingers.
寒冷會影響手指的****神經末梢****。

Courage / boldness

4. nerve — courage

= courage, especially in a difficult, frightening, or risky situation

****勇氣；膽量****

Examples

1. She had the ****nerve**** to speak in front of hundreds of people.
她有****勇氣****在幾百人面前發言。
2. I don't think I'd have the ****nerve**** to do that.
我想我沒有那個****膽量****那樣做。

Major figurative sense.

5. lose your nerve

= suddenly lose courage or confidence

****失去勇氣；怯場****

Examples

1. He ****lost his nerve**** just before the jump.
他在跳下去前突然****失去了勇氣****。
2. Don't ****lose your nerve**** now.
現在別****怯場****。

6. hold your nerve

= remain calm and brave under pressure

****保持鎮定；沉住氣****

Examples

1. She ****held her nerve**** and finished the presentation.
她****沉住氣****完成了簡報。
2. The player ****held his nerve**** in the final seconds.
那名球員在最後幾秒仍然****保持鎮定****。

Very high-value expression.

Audacity / cheek

7. nerve — audacity

= boldness that seems rude, shocking, or inappropriate

****厚臉皮；膽大妄為；竟敢****

Examples

1. He had the ****nerve**** to blame me for the mistake.
他竟然有那個****臉皮 / 膽子****把錯怪到我身上。
2. She had the ****nerve**** to ask for more money.
她竟然****厚著臉皮****要求更多錢。

Tone is usually negative.

8. have a nerve

BrE informal:

= behave with shocking boldness or rudeness

****真夠厚臉皮；真敢****

Examples

1. You've got a ****nerve**** asking me that!

你真是**夠厚臉皮**，竟然問我這個！

2. He's got a **nerve** complaining after what he did.
他做了那種事之後還抱怨，真是**有夠離譜**。

Emotional sensitivity

9. hit a nerve

= touch on a subject that is emotionally sensitive or personally important
觸動敏感點；戳中痛處

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The article **hit a nerve** with readers.
這篇文章**觸動了讀者的敏感點**。
2. Her question **hit a nerve**.
她的問題**戳中了痛處**。

10. touch a nerve

= affect someone emotionally because a topic is sensitive
觸及敏感處；引起強烈反應

Examples

1. The speech **touched a nerve** in the audience.
這場演講**觸動了觀眾的敏感處**。
2. The issue clearly **touched a nerve**.
這個議題顯然**引起了強烈反應**。

Very close to **hit a nerve**.

Irritation / emotional strain

11. nerves — nervous tension

Plural:

= feelings of anxiety, tension, or nervousness

****緊張；神經緊繃；焦慮****

Examples

1. Her ****nerves**** were beginning to show.

她的****緊張情緒****開始表現出來。

2. The interview really tested my ****nerves****.

那次面試真的很考驗我的****神經 / 心理承受力****。

12. get on someone's nerves

= annoy or irritate someone

****惹某人心煩；令某人很煩躁****

Examples

1. That constant tapping really ****gets on my nerves****.

那種不停敲打的声音真的很****煩人****。

2. His complaining is starting to ****get on her nerves****.

他的抱怨開始讓她****很心煩****。

Very high-value idiom.

13. nerves of steel

= exceptional calmness and courage under pressure

****鋼鐵般的意志；非常沉著****

Examples

1. Surgeons need ****nerves of steel****.

外科醫生需要有****非常沉著的心理素質****。

2. She showed ****nerves of steel**** during the emergency.

她在緊急情況下展現了****驚人的鎮定****。

Composure / control

14. steady your nerves

= calm yourself when anxious or frightened

****穩定情緒；讓自己冷靜****

Examples

1. He took a deep breath to ****steady his nerves****.
他深呼吸來****穩定情緒****。
2. She drank some water to ****steady her nerves**** before speaking.
她發言前喝了些水讓自己****冷靜下來****。

15. frayed nerves

= state of being emotionally worn down or highly tense

****神經緊繃；情緒疲憊****

Examples

1. Weeks of uncertainty left everyone with ****frayed nerves****.
幾星期的不確定讓大家都****神經緊繃****。
2. The constant noise wore on their ****frayed nerves****.
持續的噪音讓他們本已****緊繃的神經****更加吃不消。

Medical / physical expressions

16. pinched nerve

= nerve compressed by surrounding tissue

****神經受壓；夾壓神經****

Examples

1. A ****pinched nerve**** can cause pain or numbness.
****神經受壓****可能引起疼痛或麻木。

2. The doctor suspected a ****pinched nerve**** in his neck.

醫生懷疑他的頸部有****神經受壓****。

17. nerve damage

= injury to one or more nerves

****神經損傷****

Examples

1. The accident caused permanent ****nerve damage****.

那次事故造成永久性的****神經損傷****。

2. Diabetes can sometimes lead to ****nerve damage****.

糖尿病有時會導致****神經損傷****。

Related forms

18. nervous

A. anxious

****緊張的；焦慮的****

1. I felt ****nervous**** before the interview.

面試前我感到很****緊張****。

B. relating to nerves / nervous system

****神經的****

2. The disease affects the ****nervous system****.

這種疾病會影響****神經系統****。

19. nervous system

= network of brain, spinal cord, and nerves

****神經系統****

Examples

1. The brain is part of the **nervous system**.
大腦是**神經系統**的一部分。

2. Stress can affect the **nervous system**.
壓力可能影響**神經系統**。

20. nervy

Has two important senses depending on region/context.

A. bold / cheeky

大膽的；厚臉皮的

1. That was a **nervy** thing to say.
那樣說真的很**大膽 / 厚臉皮**。

B. tense / anxious

Especially BrE:

緊張不安的

2. The final minutes were **nervy**.
最後幾分鐘令人**緊張不安**。

21. nervously

= in an anxious or tense manner

緊張地；不安地

Examples

1. She smiled **nervously**.
她**緊張地**笑了笑。

2. He waited **nervously** outside.
他在外面**不安地**等著。

High-value expressions

22. have the nerve to do something

= have the courage or audacity to do something

****有膽量 / 竟敢做某事****

Meaning depends on tone.

Positive/neutral

****有勇氣****

1. She had the ****nerve to challenge**** the decision.

她有****勇氣****質疑這個決定。

Negative

****竟敢；厚著臉皮****

2. He had the ****nerve to insult me**** and then ask for help.

他竟然****厚著臉皮****侮辱我後還來求助。

23. strike / touch a raw nerve

= touch an especially sensitive emotional issue

****戳到痛處；觸及極敏感的問題****

Examples

1. The question ****touched a raw nerve****.

那個問題****戳到了痛處****。

2. The debate ****struck a raw nerve**** in the community.

那場辯論****觸及了社區非常敏感的議題****。

Stronger than ordinary ****hit a nerve****.

24. war of nerves

= prolonged situation in which opposing sides try to weaken each other psychologically

****心理戰；意志較量****

Examples

1. The negotiations became a **war of nerves**.
談判變成了一場**心理戰**。
2. The final stage was a **war of nerves** between the two teams.
最後階段成了兩隊之間的**心理較量**。

Key contrasts

25. nerve vs courage

courage

= broad positive ability to face fear or difficulty

勇氣

nerve

= often courage under pressure, sometimes with a stronger sense of boldness

膽量 ; 膽識

Compare:

> She showed courage.

> 她展現了勇氣。

> She had the nerve to speak up.

> 她有膽量站出來發言。

26. nerve vs confidence

confidence

= belief in your own ability or judgment

自信

nerve

= courage to actually act despite pressure or fear

膽量

Someone may be confident but still lose their nerve at the last moment.

27. nerve vs audacity

****audacity****

= boldness that may be shocking or disrespectful

****膽大妄為；厚顏****

****nerve****

can carry the same negative sense informally:

> He had the nerve to complain.

> 他竟敢抱怨。

But ****nerve**** can also mean ordinary courage.

28. nerve vs anxiety

****anxiety****

= feeling of worry or fear

****焦慮****

****nerves****

= informal way to refer to nervous tension or pre-performance anxiety

****緊張情緒****

Compare:

> chronic anxiety

> 長期焦慮

> pre-exam nerves

> 考前緊張

29. hit a nerve vs resonate

****resonate****

= connect strongly with someone's feelings or experience

****產生共鳴****

****hit a nerve****

= touch something emotionally sensitive, often more painfully or sharply

****觸動敏感點；戳中痛處****

In the passage, **hit a nerve** suggests the themes did more than simply resonate—they touched something personally sensitive.

Meaning map

The central literal concept of **nerve** is:

a structure carrying signals through the body

From this develop metaphorically:

Anatomy

nerve

→ **神經**

Courage

have the nerve

→ **有膽量**

Composure

hold your nerve

→ **保持鎮定**

Anxiety

nerves

→ **緊張情緒**

Irritation

get on my nerves

→ **讓我很煩**

Passage

hit a nerve

→ **觸動敏感點 / 戳中痛處**

Audacity

the nerve to complain

→ ****竟敢 / 厚著臉皮****

The metaphor behind ****hit a nerve**** is especially transparent:

> touch a physical nerve

> → causes an immediate strong sensation

figuratively:

> touch an emotional nerve

> → causes an immediate strong emotional reaction

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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nerve — anatomy	傳遞身體感覺與訊號的神經
nerve endings	感受疼痛、觸覺、溫度等的神經末梢
nerve — courage	面對危險、壓力或困難時的膽量 / 勇氣
lose your nerve	在關鍵時刻失去勇氣或信心；怯場
hold your nerve	在壓力下保持鎮定與勇氣
nerve — audacity	令人吃驚或無禮的大膽；厚臉皮 / 竟敢
have the nerve to do	有膽量做某事；負面語氣時指竟敢 / 厚著臉皮做
hit a nerve	觸及某人情緒上敏感的地方；戳中痛處
touch a nerve	引起強烈情緒反應；觸及敏感點
raw nerve	極度敏感、容易引起痛苦反應的議題
nerves — anxiety	緊張、焦慮或心理壓力
get on someone's nerves	不斷惹某人心煩 / 令某人煩躁
nerves of steel	在巨大壓力下仍極度沉著的心理素質
steady your nerves	讓自己從緊張中冷靜下來
frayed nerves	因長期壓力而神經緊繃、情緒疲憊
pinched nerve	被周圍組織壓迫的神經
nerve damage	神經受傷或功能受損
nervous — anxious	感到緊張、焦慮的
nervous — anatomical	與神經或神經系統有關的
nervous system	大腦、脊髓及神經組成的神經系統
nervy — bold	大膽甚至有點冒失 / 厚臉皮的
nervy — anxious	緊張不安的
war of nerves	雙方以心理壓力消耗對方的心理戰 / 意志較量

Passage recap

> “Some parts **hit a nerve**, especially the sections about self-blame and unrealised potential...”

Here:

hit a nerve = touch on something personally sensitive and cause a strong emotional reaction

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **戳中痛處**

* **觸動敏感點**

* **引起很深的情緒反應**

* contextually: **真的很觸動我**

Natural contextual translation:

有些部分真的很觸動我，特別是那些關於自責和未能實現潛能的段落。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

hit a nerve

= to touch on an emotionally sensitive subject that produces a strong personal reaction

觸動敏感點；戳中痛處

The most important contrasts are:

> **nerve**

> → 神經

> **have the nerve**

> → 有膽量 / 竟敢

> **lose your nerve**

> → 失去勇氣

> **get on my nerves**

> → 讓我很煩

> **hit a nerve**

> → **觸動情緒上的敏感點**

And compared with:

> **resonate**

> → 產生共鳴

****hit a nerve**** is usually sharper and more personal—it suggests the subject touches an especially sensitive emotional area.